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of Marc Garneau C.I.

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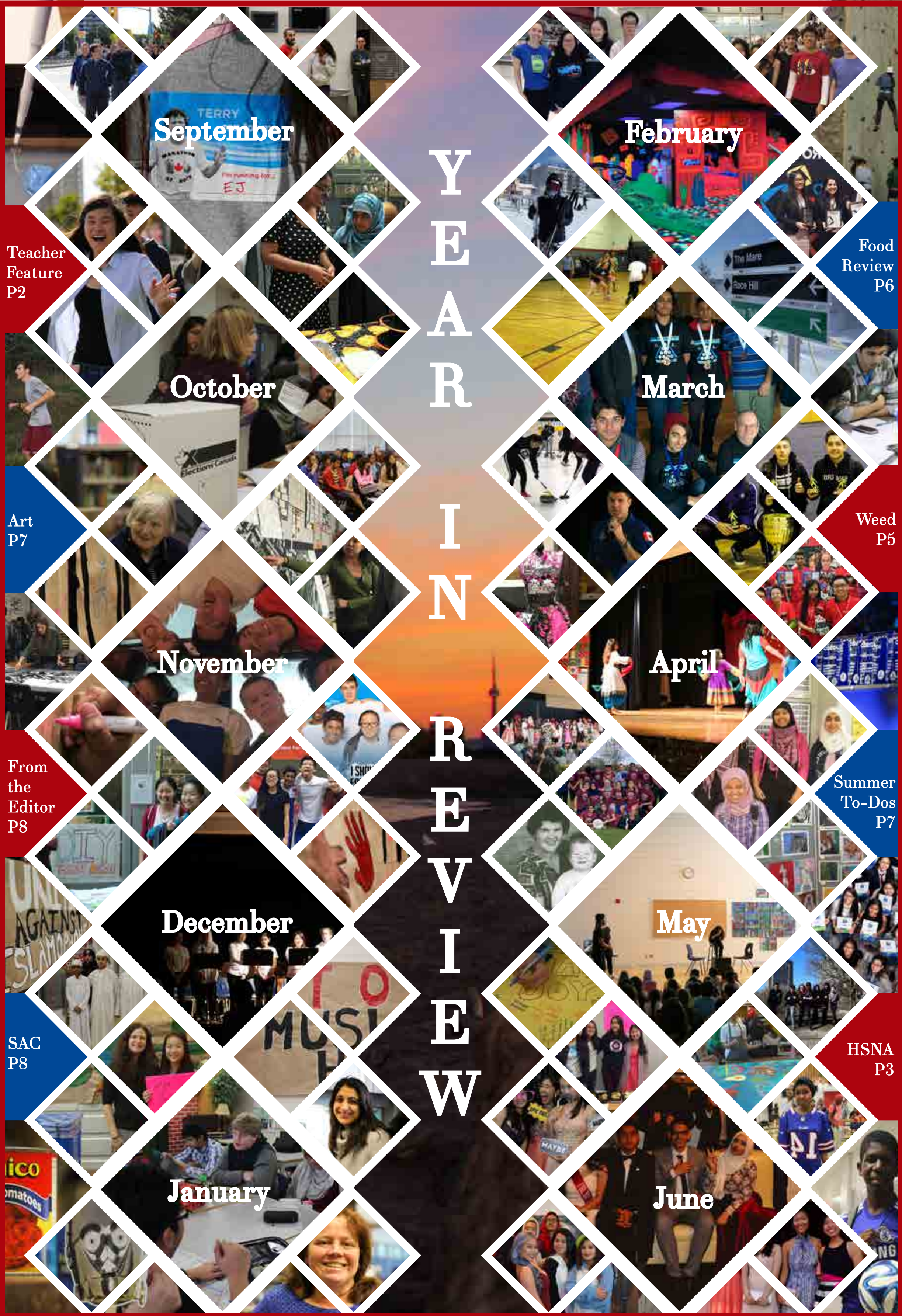
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# Teacher Feature

## MR. MIRZA

by DAVID HAO



Mr. Mirza is the curriculum leader of the Business Studies department at MGCI, and is currently in his tenth year of teaching. He is well-loved by his students for his easy-going manner and good humour.

Q: What courses do you teach at Marc Garneau?

A: I teach both Grade 11 and Grade 12 Accounting, as well as Grade 12 Finance. I also teach some other non-accounting, non-finance business courses such as Business Leadership, and the Intro to Technology in Business courses.

Q: Why business, and why teaching?

A: I feel that business is my passion. I studied business in my undergrad. I was fortunate enough to go to Schulich. I enjoyed all my professors and all my classes. Teaching is something that I got the bug for as a university student. I was teaching at a few colleges and Ryerson while I was a student, and I was a TA at Schulich. I also trained new hires while I was working. To be honest, my mother always thought that I would be a really good high school teacher. Eventually, I applied to teacher's college at U of T. So, teaching, I guess, is something that I'm passionate about and I feel that it's very dynamic as a profession. To be a role model for the younger generation is a job that I take very seriously, but it's also a job that I have a lot of fun with.

Q: What parallels do you see between the classroom and the professional workplace?

A: Because I had experience in accounting and banking prior to teaching, I always try to shape my classroom environment and tell my students that I'm preparing them for the professional world. So I would say that communication is definitely key: interpersonal skills, stress management, and problem solving. Those are the kinds of skills that I try to help students along with. Of course, the professional world is very different from the classroom environment, but these are the skills that I have felt are necessary for success, as long as you can adapt and be flexible.

Q: You were once a student at MGCI, and have been taught by a number of the school's current teachers such as Mr. Barrington and Mr. Melville. How has the dynamic changed between you and them now that you are a teacher yourself?

A: I don't think the dynamic has changed much. I have a lot of respect for all my former teachers. I've learned a lot from them, even as a teacher, on how to effectively teach and use teaching strategies in the classroom. I guess, they were my former high school teachers, now they have become my mentors. I feel that a teacher can be described as a coach, someone who tries to understand the strengths and weaknesses of their students. A teacher should try to push students in the direction where their strengths improve and where their weaknesses become their strengths.

Q: Mr. Melville said you were a gigantic nerd. Do you have any funny stories from when you were a student?

A: "Laughs" I was not, but sure, whatever

he wants to say. So Mr. Melville used to have a beard, a full facial beard, and there was a character on a sitcom at that point, the sitcom was Home Improvement, and the guy there was Al. So we used to call Mr. Melville Al, or Mr. Al, and it was very funny in the sense that I don't think he knew for a long time that students were calling him that, and it was a funny thing to say. I'm not saying we should have names for our teachers, but it just reminded me of that.

Q: So Mr. Melville is retiring this year. If there's something you could say to him right before he left, what would it be?

A: I would say thank you very much for having such a great impact on me and on everyone who he has taught in his 30+ years of teaching. His sense of humour will be greatly missed, his stories will be greatly missed, just you know, his aura was great as well. Everyone who has had him as a teacher was positively affected. And of course, all the best in his retirement, hope we can stay in touch.

Q: What do you consider your biggest pet peeve?

A: Teaching-wise?

Q: I guess so.

A: Stupidity.

Q: Why do you enjoy cricket so much?

A: I've played cricket throughout my life except for the last couple of years; now my body's given up. I've been lucky enough to play in very high-level leagues. I've represented Canada in cricket before, so it was definitely a passion for the sport. Cricket requires teamwork, leadership, communication, hard work, athleticism, so I guess a lot of the skills that a business person requires, an athlete also requires. It fits my personality.

Q: You have steeped tea very often. How do you take it?

A: Two milk, no sugar.

Q: How fast does your facial hair grow?

A: [Laughs] I guess I shave once a day.

Q: What do you consider your greatest strength? When we asked you this question two years ago you said intelligence, which I think is perfectly valid.

A: I'd say communication.

Q: Who had the biggest influence on your professional career?

My father. He's very open minded, very flexible. Although he's an engineer, his personality is like that of an executive. His ability to relate to clients, suppliers, staff or others is simply amazing. He has taught me so much in my life that it's unbelievable, it's incredible how much impact he's had on my life throughout. I was telling my daughters, from walking to shaving to reading to the business world, my dad has had a huge impact and taught me a great deal.

Q: What advice would you give to a student pursuing a career in business?

A: Study hard, and try to get into the best business school, best university out there. Name brand of the university has a lot to do with you because once you finish your degree, since your networking ability gears towards your alumni network. Second of all, do your research. Meet as many people as possible. Personally, I feel that the Canadian economy and the North American economy as a whole is run by small businesses. 60-70% of employees, or people, work for small businesses. So if you are studying business, don't only study from the corporate point of view, study from a small business point of view as well, and perhaps later on in your life, start thinking about being an entrepreneur because you can very easily make big dollars working for yourself.

Q: If you could say one thing to the whole student body, what would it be?

A: Be honest. Have integrity, have dignity, be proud of who you are. Education is the cornerstone to success. ■

# ONE HILL OF A RUN

by MARZAN HAMID

Feet hitting the asphalt, rushes of adrenaline, the emotional fulfilment of crossing the finish line; these are just a few of the many reasons why people love to run. The Girls Running Club of MGCI, founded by Ms. Hermanovsky, aims to provide this experience to female students at Garneau in an inclusive and competition-free environment.

Two years ago, Ms. Hermanovsky noticed that amidst all the clubs and teams at Garneau, none promoted recreational exercise or offered exercise that was free of judgement, competition, or marks.

Without competition, it is a good way to show girls that it is possible to exercise for fun. Not for school, marks or anything, just for fun," said Ms. Hermanovsky. Many of the members of the club are beginners, just learning to love running, and starting to feel a passion for exercise. Others however, are veterans who have ran for years, and

are committed to improving their fitness.

The club meets after school on Day 2s, Monday to Thursday, in front of Room 321. All members walk, stretch, and warm up in front of the school before beginning their run. Afterwards, they take a route through the trails in the valley near the school, running around 4 km in total. Usually, they run as a group and make sure to cheer everyone on while they run.

Together, the club trains for the Sporting Life 10 km Run. This event pushes the girls to work harder, and helps keep them on track to improving themselves as much as they can.

For the future, Ms. Hermanovsky wants to increase the number of club members. Ultimately, she hopes to change the definition of exercise for girls at Marc Garneau. ■

# PROM

by DEIFILIA TO



Grade 12 students celebrated their final days of high school at The Grand Luxe on 2 June 2016. Students wish to thank the Prom Committee, along with Ms. Lajeunesse and Ms. Collusa, for making prom possible this year. The slogan for the event was "A Night to Remember," and was inspired by a Hollywood theme. The Prom Committee wanted students to have a festive night to remember high school by. The doors opened at 6:00 pm, and students remained in the banquet hall until midnight.

This year, early bird tickets were sold for \$95. After the early bird period, prices increased by \$10, selling for \$105. However, student council held a one-day flash sale after all regular sales were complete, selling tickets for \$110. All guest tickets were sold for \$10 more than the tickets for Garneau students. In total, around 225 tickets were sold.

Soodaba Massoud, SAC's Grad Convener, had originally promised to lower the price of prom. However, she chose to give students more luxuries, instead of lowering the price.

In accordance to the Hollywood/Red Carpet theme, the awards categories were organized in a fashion similar to the Oscars. Students who won different categories got trophies, and the Prom King and Queen were given crowns. There was an open popcorn bar at 10:30 pm.

At the door, students were greeted by administrative staff (and bouncers), who checked the students' torsos as well as student IDs. Students who purchased their corsages through the school could pick them up inside the hall.

Before dinner, the graduates had the opportunity to spend time with their friends, and take photos with the backdrop. There was also a photobooth, run by PhotoBooth TO. The photos can be seen on photoboothto.com (the access code is Prom2016). Students could dress up in costumes and take a series of photos with their friends. Every student received a printout of the photos.

Dinner consisted of a house salad, a chicken or vegetarian entrée, and a three-part dessert that included a mini lava cake, cheesecake, and crème brûlée, followed by the awards and the dance.

This year, Soodaba added several new awards, including the "Best Hair, Hijab, or Hat". This was done so that all students would be fairly considered for awards.

The awards this year are as follows.

- Most likely to win the lottery and then lose their ticket: Le-mar Shah
- Most likely to be late to their own wedding: Maryam Hasan
- Most likely to cure cancer: Gul-e Rana
- Most likely to have their own reality show: Christine Mwangi
- Best hair, hijab, or hat: Seema Mahida
- Best couple: Faizan Amir and Fatima Waheed
- Best dressed male: Zain Ahmed
- Best dressed female: Afrah Islam
- Most humorous: Muneeb Hashimi
- In case of emergency, call: Saffiya Lulat
- Prom King: Faizan Amir
- Prom Queen: Hajra Arif

Hajra Arif was nominated Prom Queen, and in response to hearing her name announced, she said that "I was really shocked. I didn't think I was going to win it." She went on to explain that, after she felt the initial reaction, "I was just really thankful to all of my friends, and peers at school."

This year's prom ran smoothly. However, leading up to the event, it was difficult for the prom committee to sell tickets. International Show and Spring Fling tickets were being sold at the same time as prom tickets, discouraging students from purchasing tickets early. As well, prom tickets could not be subsidized by SAC, due to the school's limited budget. Fortunately, ticket sales did go up in the last few days, allowing the event to take place.

The students had fun celebrating the end of their high school journey. As Soodaba said, "This year's prom was a great way to end off the senior year, and will be a night to remember." ■



# Saffiya Lulat: Saying Goodbye

by HARGUN KAUR

Every year, the Marc Garneau valedictorian is chosen through a competitive application process. Applicants begin by filling out an application form which requires the signatures of ten graduating students, two teacher references, and three reasons why the candidate believes they deserve the position. The candidate's academics and extracurricular involvement are then reviewed by the commencement committee. The committee looks for a strong academic performance and a high level of extracurricular involvement to ensure that the applicant's achievements are representative of the entire graduating class. Lastly, voting lasts for just over a week. Graduating students elect the individual who they want to represent them.

Saffiya Lulat was selected to represent this year's Graduating Class of 2016. Saffiya was chosen amongst hundreds of the graduating students to make a speech at

the annual graduation ceremony, which will be held at Ryerson Theatre on 29 June 2016. She believes that although all the candidates were very qualified, her "ability to equally socialize with the different groups and communities" was crucial in making her this year's valedictorian.

Saffiya has also been an active member of various clubs and committees, both in and out of the school community. She is currently the President of the Muslim Student Association, and a member of the Syrian Club, the International Show Committee, and Habitat for Humanity. Along with her many in-school commitments, Saffiya takes time out of her schedule to volunteer at mosques, and for the Toronto Police. When she's not volunteering, she enjoys reading and absolutely adores eating. In fact, she is known as 'cookie' by many of her friends because of her intense love for chocolate chip cookies.

Saffiya came from Valley Park Middle School, and admitted that the new atmosphere of Garneau was daunting when she was in Grade 9. However, she gradually became more comfortable. This allowed her to "put herself out there", a characteristic she believes was key in her election as valedictorian.

"In Grade 9, I used to hang out with my buddies from middle school, but as we moved on and chose different classes, we all split," she said. "Throughout high school I learned to make new friends, try new things, and take advantage of any opportunities that came my way."

When asked about what she'll miss after graduating from Garneau, Saffiya replied, "It's my friends, classmates, and teachers, like Ms. Goldenberg, Ms. Woodley and Ms. Alam." She said that the teachers helped her reach her goals.

Next year, Saffiya will be attending University of Guelph-Humber's Justice Studies program, and she aspires to attend law school after completing her undergraduate degree. With her final year at Garneau coming to an end, she hopes to use her valedictorian speech to commemorate the hundreds of high school journeys which will be ending this year.

As well, she hopes to inspire her peers to continue to strive to do their best and to appreciate the accomplishments which have allowed them to come this far.

As advice to aspiring valedictorians, Saffiya said, "Make sure you speak to everyone, get to know them, and let them get to know you." But as a word of caution, she added, "While you write your speech, you'll be trying to impress everyone but remember, they chose you to represent them. Don't lose your touch along the way."

Saffiya Lulat has helped shape Garneau. Her strong involvements in the school community and her local neighborhood have created an impact in the lives of others. The Reckoner wishes Saffiya, along with all other students in the Graduating Class of 2016, the best of luck on their future endeavours. ■



Photo: Valiant Chan

# Expanding the Garneau Family

by CHENG CHENG LIN

Over the course of the 2016 year, Marc Garneau C.I. has welcomed a number of Syrian refugees into its student body. While the initial flow of immigrants began in December 2015, a significant amount arrived in February; these immigrants are both privately sponsored, and government sponsored refugees. One of the individuals who helps facilitate their transition, Ms. Malika Shah, is MGCI's School Settlement Worker. As a member of the Thorncliffe Neighbourhood Office, Ms. Shah says approximately forty-five Syrian students visit her regularly and attend her groups.

Ms. Shah's helps run various programs and services in the school community to help immigrant students adapt to the new culture. Alongside the Thorncliffe Neighbourhood Office, she offers a number of helpful clubs and groups for immigrants looking for ways to excel further in school. For example, Garneau has a LEAP program that aims to help students who have gaps in their education, and many Syrian refugees meet the criteria. Ms. Shah says that "Garneau has been very accommodating to students in need of the program."

As well, teachers, guidance counsellors, and the school in general are helping the new immigrants by working with the Thorncliffe Neighbourhood Office to offer English Conversation Classes in the summer at MGCI. These classes are meant to be a resource for students who are unable to take summer school courses, and will help them become more confident when speaking English.

Another concern that the Thorncliffe Neighbourhood Office hopes to address is the difficulty for refugees to gain work and networking experience.

# The Reckoner Named Best Volunteer Newspaper



Photo: Cindy Cui

by RUSSELL IJAYA

On 26 May 2016, staff members from *The Reckoner* attended the Toronto Star High School Newspaper Awards (HSNA) at the Toronto Star Printing Plant. *The Reckoner* once again won a number of awards, including Best Volunteer Newspaper (with over 15 staff) and Best Electronic Newspaper. Many individuals on *The Reckoner's* Fifth Guard were recognized for their skills in drawing, photography, opinion and news writing.

At the event, attendees participated in a luncheon and a tour of the *Toronto Star* printing facility. The tour was considered the highlight of the event by many attendees. According to Marzan Hamid, a News Board writer, "It was amazing to see the real printing process! The experience definitely gave us insight into how a real newspaper operation is run on a day to day basis."

The winners of the Toronto Star High School Newspaper Awards can be found below:

- Comics (1st Place) – CRYSTAL ZHANG
- Reporting (Runner-up) – RYAN LIN
- Editorial Writing (Runner-up) – DAVID HAO
- Opinion Writing (1st Place) – KHARI THOMAS
- Photography-Sports (Runner-up) – JENNA WONG
- Sports Writing-Reporting (Runner-up) – DEIFILIA TO
- Layout & Design-Page (1st Place) – ANTHONY CHANG
- Electronic-Layout & Design (1st Place) – MICHAEL KIM
- Best Electronic Newspaper (1st Place) – THE RECKONER STAFF
- Best Newspaper-Over 15 Staff (1st Place) – THE RECKONER STAFF
- Brad Henderson Award – DAVID HAO

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                               |                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| The Brad Henderson award is given to a student who demonstrates exemplary leadership and journalistic potential. The winner is awarded \$500 and a tour of the <i>Toronto Star's</i> newsroom. This year's honour was given to <i>The Reckoner's</i> Editor-in-Chief, David Hao. |                                               |                                               |
| <i>The Reckoner</i> won \$500 for being named Best Electronic Newspaper, and \$500 for being named Best Newspaper-Over 15 Staff. The money will be used to fund <i>The Reckoner's</i> Sixth Guard. Congratulations to all staff who were recognized at this year's awards. ■     |                                               |                                               |
| The Reckoner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                               |                                               |
| of Marc Garneau C.I.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                               |                                               |
| EDITOR IN CHIEF<br>DAVID HAO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | EDITORIAL MANAGER<br>PARNIKA GODKHANDI        | OUTREACH MANAGER<br>SOPHIA SONG               |
| DEPUTY EDITOR IN CHIEF &<br>LIFE MANAGER<br>CINDY ZENG                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MEDIA MANAGER<br>VALIANT CHAN                 | DIRECTOR OF<br>WEB DEVELOPMENT<br>MICHAEL KIM |
| NEWS MANAGER<br>DEIFILIA TO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | DIRECTOR OF<br>PRINT DEVELOPMENT<br>SHELA QIU |                                               |



Lauren Chang with the new additions to the school library. Photo: Valiant Chan

# Lauren Chang Wins 50 Books for School Library

by SHERRIE CHENG

On 12 May, 2016, the Canadian Broadcasting Company (CBC) announced the finalists for the 2016 Shakespeare Selfie student writing competition. Grade 11 Lauren Chang was the grand prize winner in the Grades 10 to 12 category with her soliloquy 'My Mistress With A Monster Is In Love'.

The challenge was to write a modernized soliloquy or monologue from the perspective of a Shakespearean character based on a prominent news or pop culture event that occurred between April 2015 and April 2016. Over 500 students from across Canada participated. The submissions were judged by bestselling young adult author Kenneth Oppel. The winners were selected on a variety of factors, including the originality of the subject, use of language and writing style. Lauren was later featured on CBC reading her soliloquy. It can be found at the following link: <http://www.cbc.ca/books/2016/05/my-mistress-with-a-monster-is-in-love-by-lauren-chang.html>

Lauren entered the competition because of the interesting prompt. She also said that "I never turn down the opportunity to write something that not only rhymes, but uses iambic pentameter." As the grand prize winner, Lauren won an iPad Mini and fifty young adult novels for the school library. ■



# EDITORIAL

## I'M ANGRY ABOUT RAPE AND YOU SHOULD BE TOO

by CINDY ZENG

Suppose you have a nice leather jacket. Armani, high-end. One night, somebody beats you up and steals the jacket. You go to the police and report the theft, but instead of following through with the investigation, they question you: *Why were you out at night? Were there any witnesses? Are you sure this happened? Have you let other people borrow your jacket before? Do you have a history of lending your jackets to people? Did you say "no"? Did you say "no" explicitly? Why didn't you fight harder?* You feel uncomfortable and decide not to press charges. You used to lend your jacket to others all the time. Now, the thought makes you queasy and upset. You grow paranoid, depressed. People make jokes, like *can I borrow your jacket too?* You do not laugh. Others tell you that *it's your fault for showing off your jacket like that*. And still others call you an attention seeking liar.

"Theft Prevention Tips!" says: "Avoid walking home at night, wear layered clothing, attack the solar plexus, scream 'fire' not theft, watch how much you drink..." Every day you strap on pepper spray like a soldier going to war. You wonder why the responsibility falls on your shoulders. You wonder why you didn't fight harder. You wonder if maybe it is your fault.

Ladies and gentlemen, this is rape culture. Rape culture teaches young girls to not dress "provocatively," tells them that "boys will be boys, they can't help themselves," and establishes sexual violence as the norm. Rape culture normalizes hypermasculinity and promotes victim blaming. Rape culture is incredibly dangerous and very, very common.

You perpetuate rape culture every time you excuse the actions of a "boy with his life ahead of him." Every time you express disbelief at accusations against a high-profile celebrity like Bill Cosby or Johnny Depp. Every time you write off male propagated sexual aggres-

sion as something natural, or worse, *attractive* (looking at you, Christian Grey). Recently, former Stanford swimmer Brock Allen Turner was found unanimously guilty of three felony sexual assault charges. He was caught raping an unconscious 23-year-old woman behind a dumpster at a frat party while drunk. Instead of the maximum 14 years of state prison Judge Aaron Persky could have doled out, he sentenced Turner to 6 months of county jail and community service. Persky said that Turner had "less moral culpability" due to his intoxication, and that the "prison sentence would have a severe impact on him." [1] Turner's father wrote that "Brock's life has been deeply altered forever by the events... a steep price to pay for 20 minutes of action."

Let's get one thing straight. Rape is not an accident or an isolated event; it is the intentional objectification and sexual domination of another person's body. It is about power, control, and submission. It is not a trivial event, not just "bad sex," not "worse for a virgin than a sexually active person," and absolutely not just "20 minutes of action." It is inherently humiliating and damaging. Whether the victim is unconscious or not, they will face intense psychological trauma for the rest of their lives. Rape culture excuses the actions of violent star athletes by essentially saying, "boys will be boys." It places the fault on girls for drinking too much and drawing the boys in like some coo vixen.

The desire for power and control stems from our culture of hypermasculinity, where boys are taught to not show weakness and instead strike a façade of manly strength. This is harmful to all genders. Traditionally feminine activities like cooking and embroidery are ridiculed while traditionally masculine activities are heralded. Toxic phrases like "real men don't cry" are tossed around, creating an environment where boys

bottle up their feelings and release them in explosive displays of male aggression expressed towards women. This culture especially affects males who get raped. Often, their claims are not taken seriously, or are dismissed as sex they must have actually enjoyed. These men tend to carry their trauma secretly and alone, and are even less likely to report sexual assault than female victims.

Rape is not always a man jumping out from the shadows and dragging you off to an alleyway at knifepoint. Sometimes the victim does not look like a stereotypical victim. Smoked a lot, drank a lot, dressed provocatively, wasn't she asking for it? Doesn't that make her less credible? With our justice system, the standard for whether rape occurred is placed upon the victim entirely. Their thoughts, sexual history, and actions are opened up for scrutiny, criticism, sometimes outright disbelief. It is no wonder that around 66% of sexual assault cases go unreported and less than 2% of rapists are ever actually incarcerated [2]. (These are generous estimates; the reality is probably much worse.) When they are reported, people think they're lying. Disregarding the fact that reporting rape is a very traumatizing process, statistically only 2-8% of rape reports are false reports [3]. We must dispel the idea that rape victims are lying, because the overwhelming majority of the time, they are not. This kind of mentality creates a toxic environment that prevents the victims from speaking out.

Rape happens because as a society, we have failed. Rape kits go untested for years on end. Rapists get off with little more than a slap on the wrist. Sexual objectification begins at increasingly younger ages. Hollywood normalizes violence by featuring women who get brutalized in creative ways, thereby desensitizing us to violence, and enforcing the idea that sexual abuse is common and natural. Movies like Fifty Shades of

Gray paint male aggression as romantic and promote abusive relationships. Music such as "Blurred Lines" and "What Do You Mean?" convey the idea that undesired sexual advances are the fault of women for not being clear enough in their refusal.

We can stop contributing to rape culture by acknowledging the real problems: violent masculinity and victim blaming. Start teaching boys from young ages about consent and to respect women. Stop extolling them for getting laid and deriding females for doing the same. Stop enforcing archaic gender roles and stereotypes.



Illustration: Jeffrey Liu

Rape is a big deal. It's time we start treating it like one.

[1] <http://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2016/jun/06/stanford-sexual-assault-judge-recall>

[2] <https://rainn.org/statistics/criminal-justice-system>

[3] [https://www.themarshallproject.org/2015/12/16/an-unbelievable-story-of-rape?utm\\_campaign=interstitial&utm\\_source=internal&utm\\_medium=referral&utm\\_term=victim](https://www.themarshallproject.org/2015/12/16/an-unbelievable-story-of-rape?utm_campaign=interstitial&utm_source=internal&utm_medium=referral&utm_term=victim)

[5] Asking For It: The Alarming Rise of Rape Culture – and What We Can Do About It by Kate Harding



# EDITORIAL

## BREAKING UP THE JOINT

by RAFIQ HABIB

On 26 May 2016, the Toronto Police raided 43 marijuana dispensaries in the City of Toronto, arresting 90 people and laying 186 charges in a sting operation dubbed "Operation Claudia." It was the climax of a month of media and public scrutiny of Toronto's marijuana scene that saw the number of dispensaries more than double from 32 to 69 from the end of April to the end of May [1]. Toronto Zoning Bylaw 438-86 and its amendments, which allow licensed marijuana dispensaries to operate only in the city's industrial areas, justified the police action. The targeted dispensaries violated this bylaw.

These raids have spurred debate within the city, with pot activists proclaiming that the police should have left these dispensaries alone. The activists contend that the dispensaries should be allowed to continue operating, even if this would technically be against the law. After all, the federal government has announced that marijuana legislation will be coming in 2017. These activists also believe that moving these dispensaries would adversely impact those who require marijuana for medical treatment.

For these activists to demand that this bylaw be ignored is ridiculous in itself. To say that the police should not have taken action as they saw fit is even more preposterous. The role of the police is to follow and uphold the entire law, as it stands—they cannot arbitrarily yield to people's wishes. To follow some parts of the law, while ignoring others, would set a dangerous pre-

cedent. Additionally, marijuana legislation, although planned to be introduced in 2017, may take months, or even years, to become law. Even when that occurs, there is no guarantee that these dispensaries will be allowed to operate as they do now. Currently, there is no regulation for these dispensaries, nor any quality control checks in place, making it extremely difficult to protect marijuana users that purchase the product from these facilities.

It would be incorrect to suggest that the police were not working alongside the community. The police tried to work with dispensary owners, having issued warnings to illicit dispensaries to give them time to shut down or relocate. And yet, the majority of the stores ignored the warnings, and the police had to carry out Operation Claudia. They had no other choice.

The assertion by pro-marijuana Torontonians that closing or relocating these dispensaries would make it more difficult for those with a prescription to procure medical marijuana is ill-conceived. Moving marijuana dispensaries to industrial zones will not inconvenience those with a prescription—it is legal to mail marijuana from licensed sellers to patients, actually making it more convenient for patients if they do not want to make the trip to the industrial side of town. What this move will do is make it harder for those who do not have a prescription to obtain marijuana. It will make marijuana less appealing to youth. It will make marijuana harder to mar-

ket to vulnerable people. All of these effects are the intended purpose of the current law. People who do not need marijuana for a medical reason should not be able to get it, because marijuana is still illegal in Canada.

It is time that Torontonians remember that laws are in place to be followed. Until these laws are changed, individuals have no right to willingly rebuff them.

[1] <http://www.thefader.com/2016/05/27/toronto-weed-dispensaries-operation-claudia-timeline>



Illustration: Joy Wang

## BRING ON THE BANDWAGONERS

by VICTOR YU

In the 2016 basketball season, the Toronto Raptors won their first playoff series for the first time in fifteen years. Fans of the basketball team were ecstatic, proud of the team they always believed in. But these fans weren't alone—the Raptors also received an overwhelming amount of support from *bandwagoners*.

Bandwagoners are sports fans who choose to support a team solely because of the team's recent success. Since their loyalty is founded upon the team's triumphs, as soon as the team's performance begins to falter, bandwagoners will often choose to shift their support to another more successful team. Those who consider themselves "true fans" of a team look down on these bandwagoners, frowning upon their flighty behaviour. But bandwagoners don't deserve this type of criticism, as their actions are beneficial to not only themselves, but also to the success and recognition of the teams they support.

Before judging bandwagoners, it is key to realize that the purpose of sports teams is to provide entertainment for their viewers. Fans like to watch games because it is an enjoyable way to pass time, and it gives them a common point of discussion with friends who are also fans. From this perspective, bandwagoning seems like a logical process. Supporting a sports team that is consistently winning its games is certainly more satisfying than watching a team that is always losing. The cheering, excitement, and thrill that come from watching a sports game are heavily reliant on the team's ability to perform exceptionally well and win matches. As a fan, it is emotionally draining to keep cheering for a team that is losing. Thus, the logical course of action would be to cheer for the team that is currently performing well. Chances are, many other bandwagoners have also chosen this course of action, and this way, these fans can connect with each other by cheering for the same team. Humans are social beings, so the fact that other people are also bandwagoning makes it all the more appealing. The purpose of sports teams is to bring their supporters happiness, and bandwagoners are simply trying to maximize the enjoyment they receive from watching sports.

So what makes a person a true fan? Some would argue that the determining factor is loyalty. True fans persevere with the team they love, even through periods of continuous failure; that is, even if the team's performance falters, true fans will resist the urge to go cheer on a different winning team. Through thick and thin, these fans feel that their dedicated support is what gives them the right to appreciate the success of the team. Other true fans like to believe geographical factors are an important aspect of being a true fan. If you live in Canada, then what gives you the right to support a soccer team from England?

But the arguments made by these so-called true fans come off as self-righteous and unfounded. Their resolute support is to be respected, but that does not give them the right to ridicule bandwagoners. Ultimately, true fans should wish for the success of their favourite sports team. If bandwagoners have a positive impact on the team, then they should be encour-

aged. Although their support may be temporary, bandwagoners often purchase merchandise, buy tickets to games, and even discuss the results of games with their friends. These are all actions that will benefit the revenue, publicity, and confidence of the sports team—it undoubtedly feels better to have a full stadium of cheering fans, rather than a small handful of dedicated fans.

When it comes to supporting a team, everyone has to start somewhere. It just makes more sense to start with a team that is winning, as opposed to one that is always losing. Who knows? Some bandwagoners may choose to stick around even when the sports team begins to lose. Regardless of their choices later on, bandwagoners should be appreciated for their present contributions and support for the team. So don't be afraid to jump on the bandwagon.



Illustration: Jeffrey Liu

## INFLATED MARKS LEAD TO DEFLATED SUCCESS

by DAVID CHEN-LI

The transition to university for Ontario high school students is often a daunting experience. For most, it is the dramatic shift in lifestyle that provides the greatest challenge, as first-year students struggle to manage their life without constant supervision from parents. On the other hand, academics in university should be no different from moving up a grade in high school, right? According to current trends, perhaps not.

Undeniably, academic grades have progressively inflated in past years. From 1995 to 2004, the percentage of graduates applying to postsecondary education with an A average rose from 52.6 percent to 61 percent. From 1995 to 2003, the amount of Ontario graduates with an A plus average rose from 9.4 percent to 14.9 percent. The average grade of senior students in Ontario from 1997 to 2012 rose from 80 percent to 85 percent. Although this would appear to be good news, the truth is that these increases in marks do not correspond with an increase in student success.

These rising averages mean that, in selecting the top applicants from a given graduating year, universities across Canada have to raise their admission average requirements. Rising admission requirements mean that high schools are pressured into giving even higher averages for students so that they can enter these universities. This vicious cycle is driving mark inflation in Ontario.

The problem of grade inflation first arrived when Grade 13 departmental exams were removed for Ontario students. This change came about after the publication of the Hall-Dennis report in 1968, a report calling for a complete rework of

Ontario's education system. However, departmental exams were important for graduating high school students because their entire university admission depended on their exam results. As a result of the exams' discontinuation, universities no longer had a standardized baseline to compare students. The admissions process had to be changed.

Currently, universities consider the final marks in certain high school courses, among various other requirements for admission. The issue lies in the fact that top-tier universities will often publish a minimum grade requirement for students to even be considered for admission. This means that if their grades don't meet the requirement, their application won't be reviewed at all.

This consequently puts pressure on both students and high schools to meet these application requirements in order to get into top-tier institutions. Students are no longer trying to put in extra effort to learn challenging course material. Instead, they are more inclined to seek courses that allow them to put in a minimal amount of effort while still achieving a high average. It can be surmised that students have been taking advantage of the fact that important courses—such as English—have to be significantly condensed in order for students to finish the course over the summer. High school has now become a numbers game, where the winner is whoever has achieved the highest academic average with the least amount of effort and genuine learning.

For its part, the Ontario government's Ministry of Education is looking to maintain its campaign promises by churning out a higher percentage of graduates ev-

ery year. They also want "students of all ages" to "achieve high levels of academic performance," and have "set a goal to improve access to university education and to ensure that 70 percent of Ontarians have postsecondary credentials in order to boost the province's prosperity." Their hurdle, then, is to push students who put little effort into studying towards graduation and postsecondary education. The current solution is for teachers to adjust marks for students so that they're getting higher marks relative to the amount of work they put in. Subsequently, the majority of these graduates get accepted by one university or another.

However, these adjustments are the last thing high school students need. By making it easier for students to acquire high marks in high school, graduating students expect the same in first year university. Their expectations are subsequently crushed with significant average drops in their first year. All of a sudden, students who were breezing through high school with little effort are now struggling to stay afloat in significantly more challenging university courses. Professor Alan Slavin from Trent University described a drop in the average of his introductory physics course from 66 percent to 50 percent over a ten year period from 1996 to 2006. Similar trends were found in the mathematics department at Trent. Brock University also drew attention to this issue in 2010, with a report stating that students entering universities across Canada with an average higher than 90 experienced an average drop in first year of 11.9 percent.

Not only do students have an inadequate grasp of the material that is nec-

essary for first year, but they also lack the skills and work ethic to properly learn the course material. These skills are crucial for post-secondary education and can be valuable tools to students, even after completing their education. It is obvious, then, that grade inflation is slowly destroying the next generation of students. To address the problem, one solution would be to re-integrate standardized testing. This would force students to prioritize learning course material, as it would be needed to pass the exam. It would also give universities a reliable comparison of candidates across the province and draw the focus away from mark averages. An alternative is to call for universities to consider mark inflation in their admissions process in a defined manner. The University of Waterloo currently deducts the average

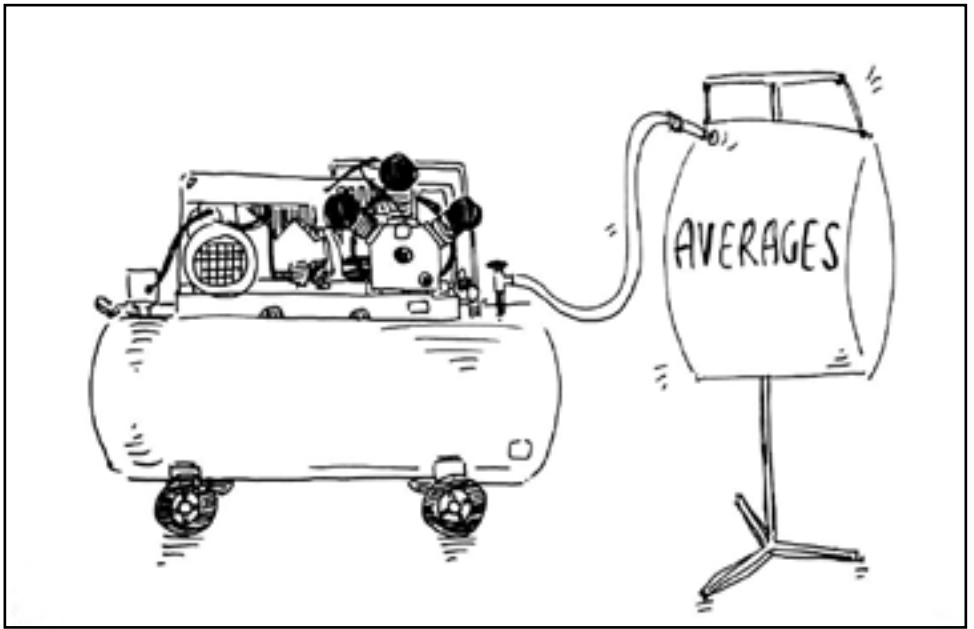


Illustration: Lila Huang

[www.thereckoner.ca](http://www.thereckoner.ca)

### ASK THE RECKONER

*I have a friend who's too clingy. He/She really likes talking to me, but I'm always annoyed whenever we engage in conversation. I want to call off our friendship, but I don't want to hurt any feelings. What to do?*  
- desperate for air

Dear desperate for air,

The truth is, sometimes we grow apart from our friends. It's nothing to be ashamed of—it just means that you're both growing up! Your friend might be clingy because they feel insecure about the changes happening around them. The best thing you can do now is confront your friend about your feelings before your resentment grows any larger. If you wait too long, your emotions might accumulate, and they might come out negatively. By allowing your friend to build their confidence, you allow them to become more independent and less clingy. Being honest is the most courteous and effective approach. Communication is key.

*Are middle hair parts socially acceptable?*  
-uncultured piglet

Dear uncultured piglet,

It is a truth universally acknowledged that middle hair parts are socially acceptable—but just barely. They're simply tolerated. When you see a middle hair part, you don't immediately think, "Dang, that is one cool bro!" as you would when seeing a sick side part. When you sport a middle part, you're simply uninteresting. Dull. *Très ennuyeux* (that's French for very boring, you uncultured swine). You can't change it up like you can with a side part. Side part: yesterday it was on the right, today it is on the left, damn son, you cray-cray! Middle part: yesterday it was on the right, today it is on the left, no wait, there's actually no difference because it's the same part... See? Boring. But, Uncultured Piglet, the decision is yours if you choose to utilize the dreaded middle hair part.

*I come from a family that isn't very well off. My parents give me everything I need, but I can tell that we're facing financial struggles. However, all my friends come from upper middle class families and I always feel self-conscious about my clothing, mannerisms, etc. whenever I'm with them, because they always spend money so freely. What do I do to feel more comfortable with who I am?*  
- penny pinching

Listen, your friends don't care about your financial situation. They're friends with you for a reason! They like you already - clothing, mannerisms, and all. Just focus on trying to be the best person you can be. Read books, listen to music, develop your social awareness. Be a nice person. It doesn't cost anything to be likeable, so remember that the amount of money you have shouldn't affect how others perceive you (and if it does, then they're probably not a good friend anyway). You do you, man. I believe in you, and you should too.

(Additionally, consider thrift shopping for all your cheap but edgy clothing needs!)

If you seek counsel from The Reckoner like the individuals above, send us a question at [www.thereckoner.ca/ask-the-reckoner](http://www.thereckoner.ca/ask-the-reckoner)



Genesis Project

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Photographer & Graphic Artist

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# THE HUNCH ON LUNCH

A REVIEW OF MGCI CUISINE

by DAVID HAO

There's a lot of places to get food around MGCI, and some are better than others. Trust me, I've been buying lunch every school day for four years. Here are my thoughts after many meals and dollars spent. The number before each restaurant indicates its position on the map, not its ranking. 3 and 6 are Subway and McDonald's, respectively. I've omitted those because you already know all about them.

**Bamiyan Kabob (9)**  
Taste: 🍴🍴🍴🍴🍴  
Healthiness: 🍴🍴🍴🍴🍴  
Service: 🍴🍴🍴🍴  
Price: \$\$\$\$  
Time to school: 10 minutes

Got cash cash money and a hungry stomach? Bamiyan Kabob is the place for you. Expect to spend around \$10 per meal here, but you won't be disappointed by the quality of your food. Both the wrap and plate options are delicious, and there are a variety of meats to choose from. Bamiyan Kabob happens to be the school admin's restaurant of choice, with many staff members citing it as a personal favourite. I really love the tangy dip for the naan bread. The only con to Bamiyan Kabob is its high price. Besides that, it's a Bami-yay!

**Caribbean Palms (5)**  
Taste: 🍴🍴🍴🍴  
Healthiness: 🍴🍴🍴🍴  
Service: 🍴🍴🍴🍴  
Price: \$\$  
Time to school: 9 minutes

Caribbean Palms primarily serves various forms of jerk chicken and stewed chicken. They offer lunch specials for \$5, which consist of brown rice with your choice of jerk chicken, stewed chicken or fried chicken. While the meat itself is not offensive, I'm disappointed by the fact that the specials have a severe shortage of vegetables: You only get three slices of cucumber. Really? The meals could be substantially augmented by substituting the cucumbers with a helping of coleslaw. It takes a notoriously long time for the store to prepare your meal. I would

allocate anywhere between 15 to 20 minutes of waiting time, so make sure you either have a spare afterwards or call ahead to place your order.

**Mulan (4)**  
Taste: 🍴🍴🍴🍴  
Healthiness: 🍴🍴🍴🍴  
Service: 🍴🍴🍴  
Price: \$  
Time to school: 9 minutes

Mulan is MGCI's quintessential Chinese restaurant. The store looks extremely sketchy, yes, but the food is quite good. There are a great deal of options such as Szechuan and black bean, although frankly most are just the same chicken or beef on rice with a different sauce. Don't bother with their fried options. Serving sizes are very generous, so bring an empty stomach or get your food in a to-go container.

**Pho Thien Phat (8)**  
Taste: 🍴🍴🍴  
Healthiness: 🍴🍴🍴  
Service: 🍴🍴  
Price: \$\$\$\$  
Time to school: 9 minutes

Pho Thien Phat is your stereotypical Vietnamese restaurant. Although pho is its biggest draw, regular rice is offered as well. Expect to pay around \$10 for a meal and be aware that you'll have to tip, since it's a sit-down restaurant with service, albeit an extremely casual one. You probably won't have time for an entire meal here during lunch, so make sure you have spare if you don't want to be late for class. As for the pho itself, it tastes like any other pho you've ever had. Not really much to say.

**Pita Land (2)**  
Taste: 🍴🍴  
Healthiness: 🍴🍴  
Service: 🍴  
Price: \$\$\$  
Time to school: 7 minutes

Pita Land is where you go after you've defended Earth from the Chitauri, or when you're hungry for shawarma. There are actually two student specials.

The new one is a pop and a falafel or gyro (beef) shawarma. The other is the old, unadvertised and more expensive special: A pop, a chicken shawarma, and a small bag of chips. I still always get the old special, because the chicken tastes better than the gyros and falafels. I recommend adding a scoop of tabouli for \$0.29; it really adds to the flavour and texture. Pita Land is a bit pricy, but its shawarmas are great.

**Popeyes (8)**  
Taste: 🍴🍴  
Healthiness: 🍴  
Service: 🍴  
Price: \$\$\$  
Time to school: 10 minutes

Popeyes is the king of "You want to go, but you know you shouldn't." The fried chicken is sure to be one of your guiltiest pleasures. Of course, it is horribly unhealthy, and the momentary bliss is quickly replaced by dark feelings of unwellness and poor decision-making soon after consumption. Keep away from the cajun poutine unless you enjoy large globs of cheese and soupy fries. A different special is offered each weekday. I consider Wednesday's offer the best: Any sandwich for \$4.79.

**Sunny Supermarket (7)**  
Taste: 🍴🍴  
Healthiness: 🍴  
Service: 🍴  
Price: \$\$  
Time to school: 9 minutes

Sunny isn't a restaurant, but they do have a mini food court for you to order various forms of Chinese food from. The food quality isn't amazing and it's all pre-made, but you can get anything from General Tso's to fried calamari to (crappy) bubble tea to eggplant stirfry. The specials they have vary from day to day, but usually the portions are so large that you should bring a friend to split with. There's also this fun machine you can put a quarter into to get a Pokémon card.

**Sweet and Samosa (11)**  
Taste: 🍴  
Price: 🍴

Healthiness: 🍴  
Service: 🍴  
Price: \$  
Time to school: 10 minutes

Most students come to Sweet and Samosa for their samosas (surprise!), which are very cheap as far as samosas go. For \$1, you can either get 3 veggie samosas or 2 chicken/beef samosas. The samosas have a mild spiciness to them, but not much else can be said about their taste. A good place for quick and cheap snack food.

**Tim Hortons (1)**  
Taste: 🍴  
Healthiness: 🍴  
Service: 🍴  
Price: \$\$\$  
Time to school: 7 minutes

Tim's is Tim's. Although the Canadian favourite excels at breakfast, I wouldn't give them a very high recommendation for lunch. The lunch menu is quite expensive and no items stand to blow your mind. If you're looking for a coffee, ice capp, or place to mingle with friends, look nowhere else, but for lunch, there

are plenty of better options.

**Watan Pizza (10)**  
Taste: 🍴  
Healthiness: 🍴  
Service: 🍴  
Price: \$  
Time to school: 10 minutes

Watan Pizza takes competitive pricing to a whole new level. The student specials are so insanely cheap here that you wonder how they make a profit. You can get any slice of pizza (your options are meat lover's, pepperoni, garden veggie, cheese, or Hawaiian) plus fries and a pop for only \$3.50, or a pop and pizza slice for \$2.25. The taste of the pizza is nothing to get excited about, just a touch better than frozen pizza. The store also offers other options like sandwiches and salads, but these are far more expensive. For maximum dollar-to-food value, Watan Pizza is my personal recommendation.



Illustration: Lila Huang

## A Late-Night Walk

by MOUJAN SADERI

As I walked in the forest, The sun in the sky, sank low. The trees trembled with fear of the dark, So the fireflies began to glow. As I walked in the forest, The wind blew fast and cold. The ground shivered and shook with frost, So the leaves Fashioned a blanket of gold. As I walked in the forest, The sleepy birds ceased to sing. The branches needed music to dance, So the crickets sang songs of spring. As I walked in the forest, The bears were counting sheep. But their eyes wouldn't close, So all the wolves rose, And howled To lull them to sleep. As I walked in the forest, The ground was covered in dew. The grass was not pleased, And the sun heard his pleas, So she rose And the sky grew blue.

I hear the voices of my classmates behind me, ecstatic about the cake sitting before them. The faint sound of a radio echoes in the background. My teacher plasters a smile on her face. Are you one? Are you two? Are you three?!

I close my eyes. *I wish to go to Centre Island with Mommy!* I exhale. The lights go out, and it is quiet.

The radio continues to murmur in the background...*terrorist...plane crash...twin towers...*

This is my view of 9/11. Were you expecting a plane crash? An image of a falling building? A person soaring through the sky, after having jumped from the 42nd floor? No. For me, it was a birthday party.



I was born on September 11, 1998. My third birthday fell on the day the Twin Towers were struck by aircrafts. 9/11 was just one of those days. A day where anyone old enough to understand remembers exactly what they were doing when they heard the news. *I was sipping coffee while watching the TV. I was running into my office building when my co-worker came to*

*me in tears with the news.* To my regret, I barely remember it. While others in New York were praying for the lives of their mothers, I was singing. *Happy birthday to me.*

When fathers were calling their children to hear their voices one last time, I looked up at my mom to smile for a photo. *Say cheese!*

While others wept, I beamed. This was my special day.

My teachers listened to news over the crackling radio. Tears shone in their eyes while they forced a smile and pretended that everything was okay for the classroom full of children that sat before them.

It is only when I consider the circumstances fourteen years later, that I realize how bittersweet the photograph is. On one hand, I was innocent and blissfully unaware of the events happening around me. It's almost endearing: young child, sweet smile, simple happiness. On the other hand, it shows the remarkable discrepancy between outward appearance, and the reality of a given situation. *Things are never as they seem.*

My three-year-old self thought that everyone experienced the world in the same way. If I was happy, then my friend must also be happy. When I cried, the world would stand with me in sorrow, feeling my pain.

*I was very, very wrong.* Everyone has a different view of the same situation. They go through life with unique conversations, relationships, and encounters. While events happen objectively, the individual experience is subjective. Even if you are standing right next to me, what I



# THE SUMMER BUCKET LIST

by CINDY ZENG

Summer is here and you know what that means! Wildness! Partying! Teenage she-nanigans! If you're feeling gutsy but don't really know where to start, *The Reckoner* has got you with a handy Summer Bucket List. Ready to get your freak on? Let's go!

- ☐ Bike to the beach and watch a sunset
- ☐ Eat two crepes at Krepesz, an awesome crepe café in Kensington Market
- ☐ Perform a mashup of 2 songs (it doesn't matter if you can't sing)
- ☐ Bike through Centre Island
- ☐ Walk a friend's dog
- ☐ Walk a friend's cat
- ☐ Read *The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy*
- ☐ Make a giant Ferrero Rocher
- ☐ Go on a midnight adventure
- ☐ Sneak into the 15th floor of a random corporate building
- ☐ Try a beaver tail
- ☐ Eat at a gourmet food truck
- ☐ Tell your parents you love them
- ☐ Walk around downtown with very conspicuous face paint
- ☐ Attend a concert
- ☐ Visit the CNE and try a deep fried Twix bar
- ☐ Skateboard down the ravine near our school
- ☐ Listen to the entire soundtrack of Hamilton
- ☐ Go to karaoke with friends
- ☐ Binge at a sushi bar
- ☐ Climb over a fence
- ☐ Set off fireworks on a night that's not a holiday
- ☐ Celebrate someone's birthday
- ☐ Plant a cactus
- ☐ Finish that book you've been meaning to fin-

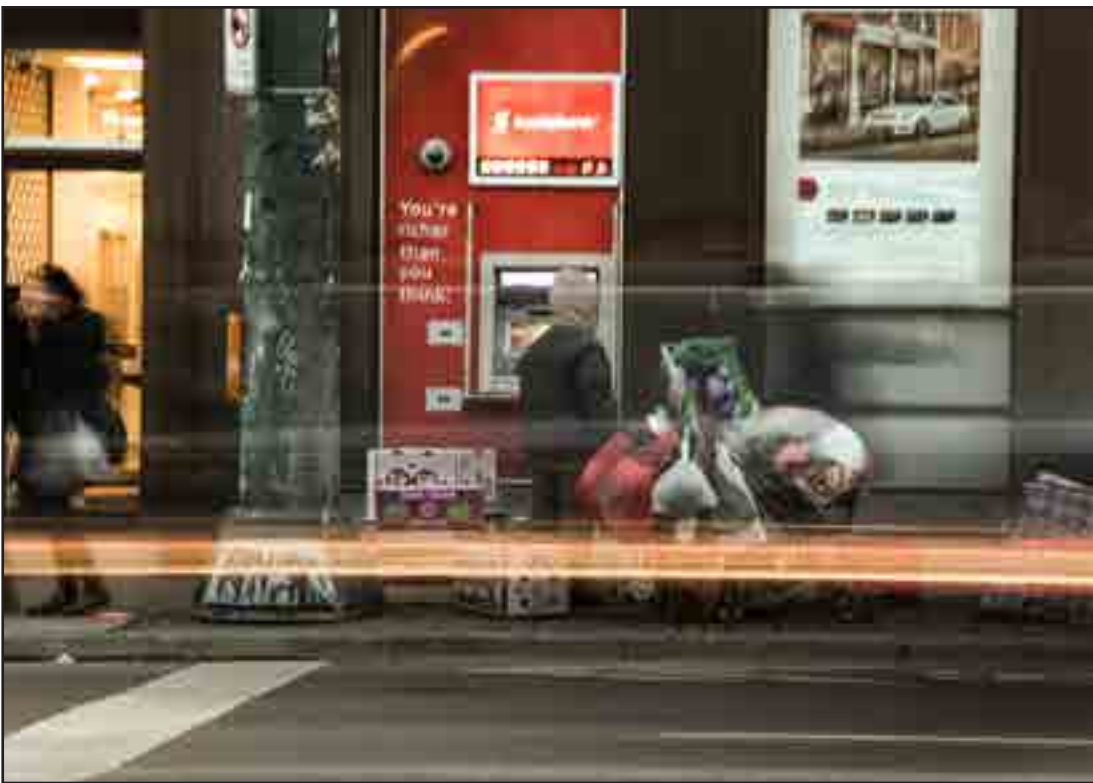
- ☐ ish
- ☐ Marathon a TV series
- ☐ Sleepover at a friend's house
- ☐ Talk to a stranger on the subway
- ☐ Give money to a homeless person
- ☐ Try every type of donut in Tim Hortons
- ☐ Go to a party
- ☐ Learn how to do a cartwheel
- ☐ Dance to Uptown Funk in the rain
- ☐ Visit the cat café before it closes
- ☐ Go camping with your friends
- ☐ Roast marshmallows over a fire
- ☐ Throw a party
- ☐ Enjoy a picnic at Edwards Gardens
- ☐ Go thrift shopping
- ☐ Go out in public dressed in a onesie
- ☐ Stargaze as best as you can under the city's light pollution
- ☐ Eat at a Summerlicious restaurant (event lasts from July 8-24)
- ☐ Make a vlog
- ☐ Watch a play downtown
- ☐ Have a lazy day in
- ☐ Watch live slam poetry
- ☐ Go to an outdoor movie screening
- ☐ Play Ultimate with your friends
- ☐ Try exercising for a day
- ☐ Take a road trip to a place you've never been before

Rock on, my dudes. We'll see you next year! ■



## Greenspace

by HELLEN LI



by VALIANT CHAN

## IGNORANCE



by GREATON TAN



Photos by Cindy Cui  
For more Humans of Garneau, visit  
[tinyurl.com/thehumansofgarneau](http://tinyurl.com/thehumansofgarneau)



As graduating seniors, what is one piece of advice you would give to niners finishing their first year of high school?

Honestly, just take it easy, enjoy your life. Don't make it harder than it needs to be.



What will you miss most about high school?

I'm going to say the people, because I've grown up with them my whole life--I've known most of them since elementary. The friends, the "meet up" spots, the jokes at lunch time. But I'm also looking forward to university. I've heard the amount of work you do in university isn't even close to what you do in high school, but I'm excited about the new people, new experiences, and trying something totally different.

# From the Editor

by DAVID HAO



a small piece of our community identity. It is here where *The Reckoner* assumes its role: We take those small pieces and weave them into the mosaic of personalities that gives life to MGCI. If at any point this newspaper has helped you gain a greater appreciation for the people around you, then *The Reckoner* has served its purpose.

My greatest privilege as Editor-in-Chief has been the opportunity to meet and work with truly remarkable people. I need to look no further than my own staff to see raw talent and skill, but my perspective would hardly do the school justice if I stopped there. I imagine no better opportunity than now to identify and thank some of these exceptional individuals:

To Ms. Goldenberg: Your open-mindedness is a daily inspiration,

To Ms. O'Flynn-Wheeler: Your enthusiasm is unparalleled,

To Ms. Ali and Mr. Gilmore: Your assistance never goes unappreciated,

To Ms. Speirs: Your unwavering support gives us life,

To Ms. Brennan: Your instruction invigorated my perspective on writing,

To the Executive Team: A better dream team I know not of,

and to the Fifth Guard: You are the lifeblood of this newspaper. Here's to you!

I am always humbled by the amount of enthusiasm that students show towards *The Reckoner*. And so in my final act as Editor-in-Chief, I challenge you, the reader, to bring our name to life. *Reckon* with us, *think* with us. It is our greatest gift to be able to consider the world around us. If you carry the spirit of inquiry, then the Sixth Guard has a spot for you.

*The Reckoner* will return in September. I am fully confident that it will continue to lead and inspire.

All the best,  
David Hao  
Editor-in-Chief

## MESSAGES TO RETIRING TEACHERS

Besides Mr. Melville and Mrs. White, Mr. Gang, Ms. Lawford, Mr. McKay, and Ms. Scheinman will also be retiring this year. They have kindly declined to be featured. *The Reckoner* wishes them all the best in their retirement and future plans.

“Honestly, you were the gloomy ray of sunshine I needed every day. It was nice spending the semester with you. Hope you enjoy your retirement away from school and away from kids and responsibilities. Hope you can begin your investment in cement trees one day.

► You taught civics better than anyone else could have! Thank you.

► Thank you for making me punctual.

► Mr. Melville, you are probably one of the few teachers in the school who have students flocking to your classes simply because you're the one teaching. I don't what part of being yelled at or getting locked out of the classroom during quizzes I found inviting, but I just had to take your economics course before you retired. Perhaps it's your snarky humour or your startlingly relevant stories of a bygone era, but you really manage to make history and the dismal science come alive. I hope you have an exciting retirement! If you ever need tech support, your old students would be glad to help.

► You once taught history, but now you ARE history! Hahaha!

► Mr. Melville you are one of my favourite teachers! I love your stories and your tales of taking advantage of countries with low value currencies. Those stories are actually the entire reason why I took economics. Hope you have a great time in Florida and please accept my friend request on Facebook.

► You are unforgettable. Though I try. Really really hard.

► Goodbye, Mr. Melville! You've made a huge impact on my life, and I felt like I was truly LIVING through history, or the world of economics, whenever you taught me. You are such a knowledgeable teacher, and always so interesting to talk to. I'm sure your retired life will be even more exciting than everything else you've done thus far. So have a blast in Florida, and go to as many Nicki Minaj/Madonna/Katy Perry concerts as you can!

► Hi Mr. Melville, it's one of your students who hasn't been to class for many days. IT'S NOTHING PERSONAL. It's always just me having to deal with some problems during the mornings. I hope you understand. Thank you for your brilliant era of teaching. Hope you have the best upcoming retirement!

► I'll miss your rants on concrete trees but they're not feasible!

► Everyone (almost) will miss you!

► When a teacher successfully terrorizes you in grade 9 but you end up loving them more and more as time goes by, you know they are someone special. I'm going to miss your humour, your sarcasm, your awesome taste in music, your movies, and especially all the times in class when you made me laugh till my stomach hurt. Thank you for everything!

“Hello Mrs. White! Of all the years I've been in the Ontario education system, and of all of the English teacher I've ever faced, no teacher has pushed me to the limits like you have. You gave me the opportunity to go past my boundaries and explore the world of English literature. From teaching us how to write a proper sentence, to teaching us how to annotate to perfection, you've taught it all. Thank you so much for not just being a great teacher, but thank you for also being there as a person. When any Garneau student need support, you're there to help them. I hope to come across many more teachers like you!

► Mrs. White, I really enjoyed your History of English lecture. I hope you'll have the opportunity to share it with more people in the future!

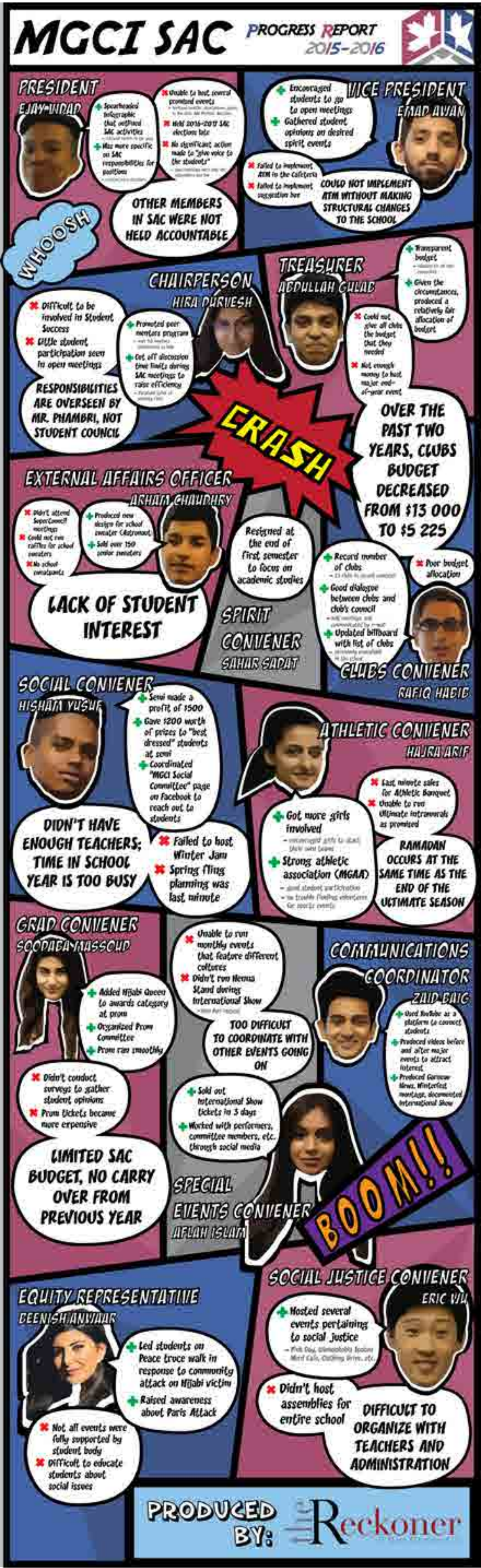
► Having had you as my English teacher for two years in a row, I am tremendously grateful for your dedication and knowledge of the subject. I know that my writing has improved as a result, and you have polished skills that I will carry with me through the rest of my life. Thank you for all your help! Please come back and visit us.

► You made studying Romeo and Juliet and Tristan and Iseult very enjoyable!

► Sorry for getting on your nerves. Hope you have a great, peaceful time in retirement!

► You were an amazing English teacher. At the beginning, it was difficult to adjust to your way of teaching, but after a while we all got the hang of it. Although you were strict at times, there was a lot that the students could learn from you. I really enjoyed your English course! Thank you!

► Mrs. White, I originally thought you were a very stern teacher, but after two years in your class I realized that you just have an exceptionally high standard of teaching and want to push your students towards their limits. My English has definitely improved because of your learning; you have taught me to consider my writing from more than one angle and to think critically. Perhaps in your retirement you will find refuge from the rowdiness of us youngsters, but I do hope you contain spreading your passion for your craft.



Infographic: Valiant Chan